

# CodeTrails

The Collaboration Primitive for Software Development.

ONE LINK

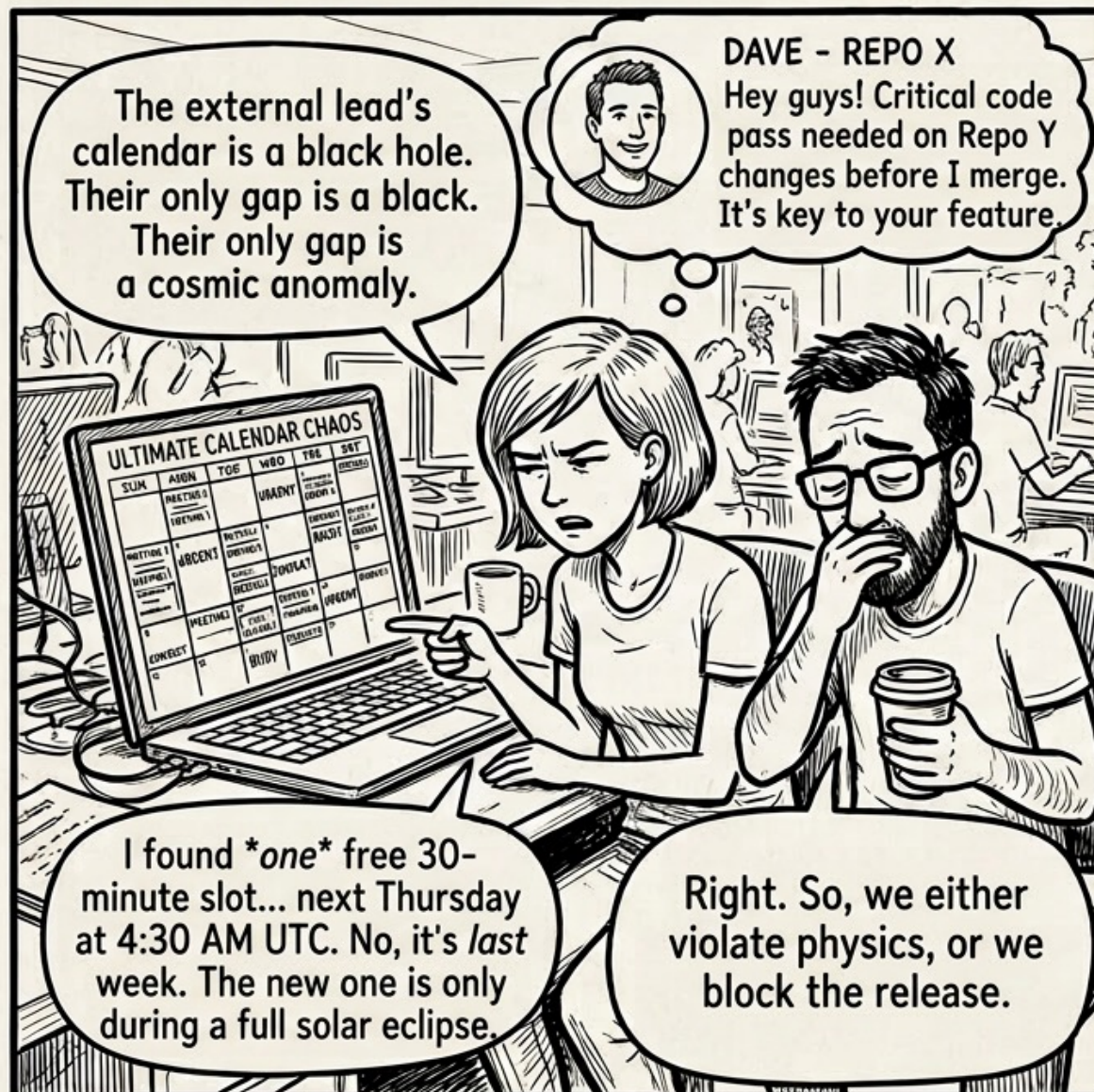
NO IDE

ANYONE CAN REVIEW

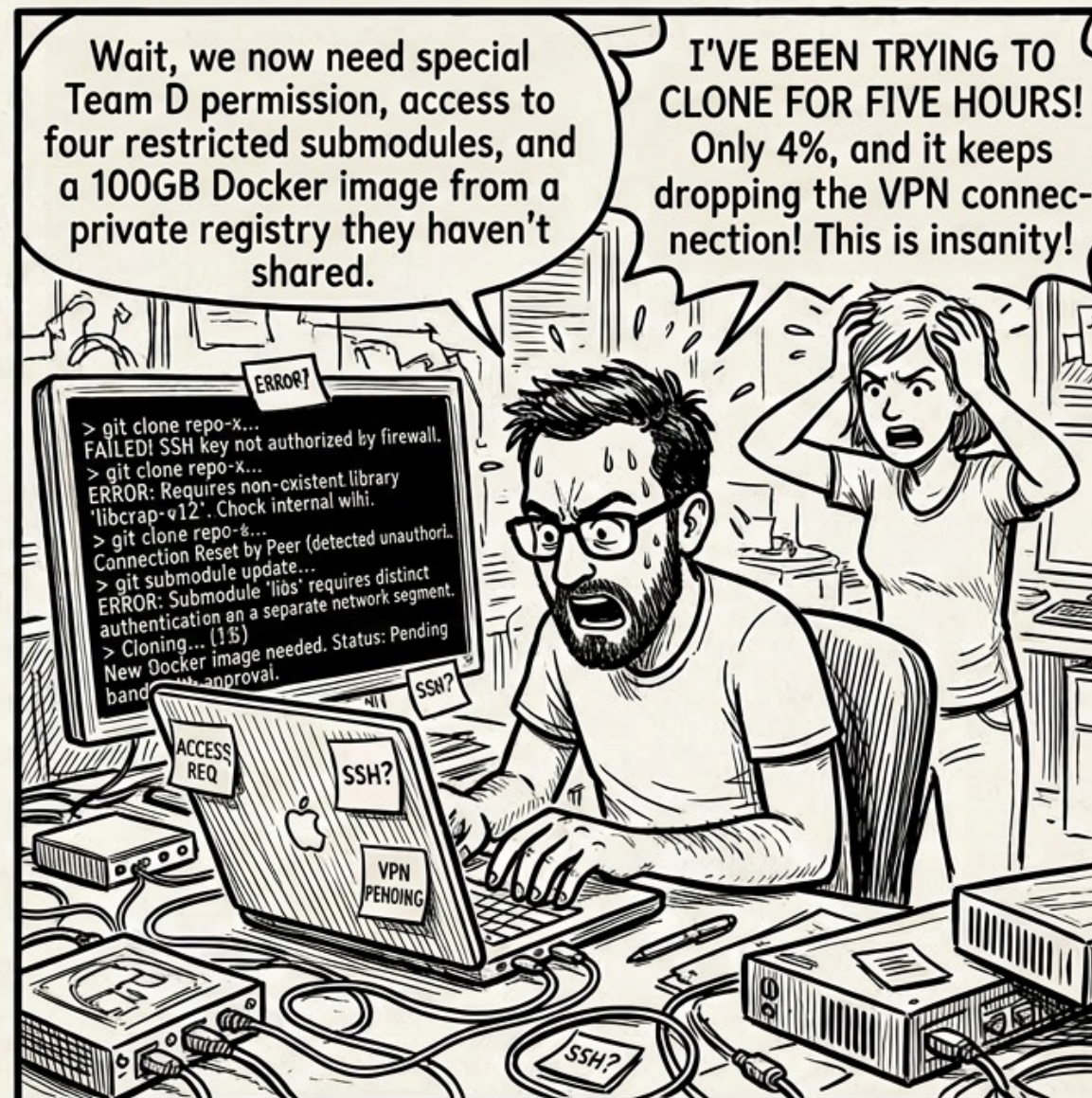


# An engineer needs feedback from someone not on their team.

## THE CALENDAR ABYSS



## THE CLONING GAUNTLET



JOKE: "How many engineers does it take to get an external PR reviewed? One to write the code, three to schedule the meeting, five to defeat the



# *Frame.io* for code.

*Same three-beat shift. New medium.*

BEFORE · 2020

## The studio

→ feedback in person

BEFORE · 2020

## Compress & pray

→ feedback over email

FRAME.IO · NOW

## One link

→ any timestamp

BEFORE · TODAY

## The meeting

→ feedback in person

BEFORE · TODAY

## Clone the repo

→ feedback in IDE

PRINCIPAL AI · NOW

## One link

→ any step

*We call it a **Code Trail**.*

# What is a Code Trail?

It's a shareable artifact. Of software or code that explains software

## 1 SPATIAL

### FileCity

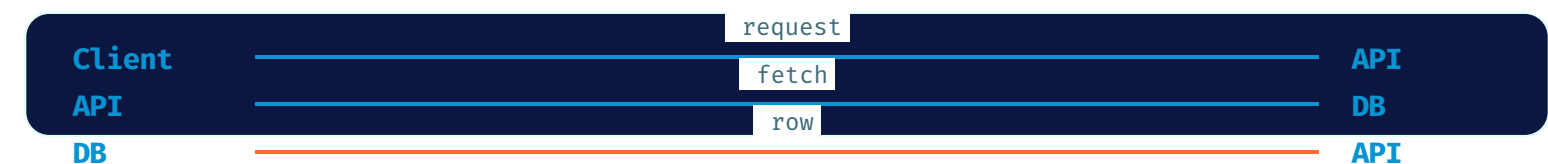
Spatial view of what changed.



## 2 FLOW

### Sequence diagram

Step-by-step execution flow.



## 3 SOURCE

### The actual code

For those who need it.

```
12 const ref = useRef(null);
13+ if (ref.current) return;
14 handler();
15 }
```

## 4 NOTES

### Plain English notes

Anchored to exact points.

**M** **useRef**  
Michael · line 13 · 2 min ago

No forking. No cloning. No IDE.

Open link.



See change.

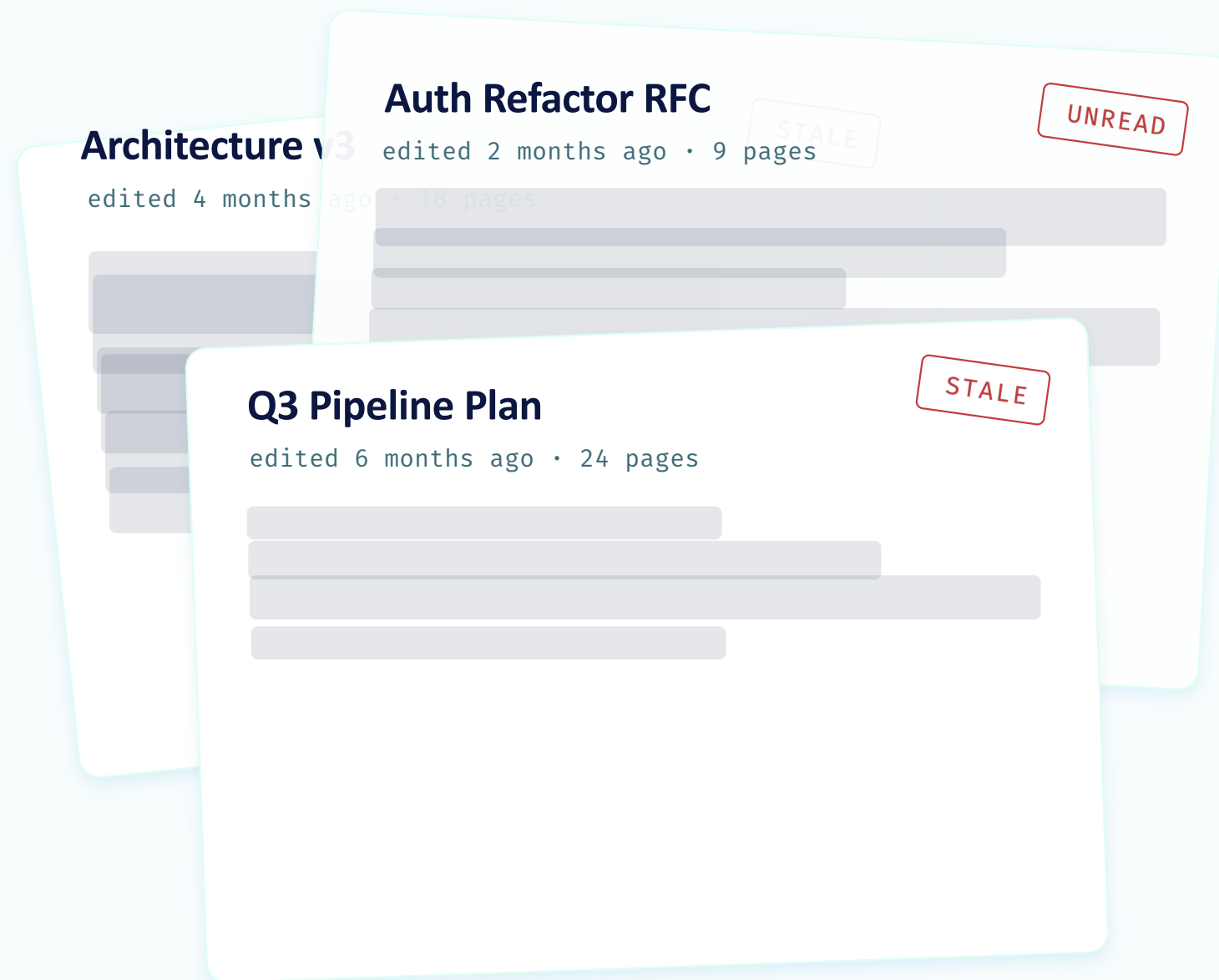


Leave note.



Done.

# Design docs are **broken**.



Engineers write them. Nobody reads them.

They live outside the code.

They get stale immediately.

Reading a doc takes you out of the code context.

## THE FIX

Code Trails are **better design docs**.

Visual. Shareable. Native to the  
codebase.

# Teams with **multiple stakeholders.**

Individual folders **owned by different teams.**

Every change **needs sign-off.**

Currently done with **design docs and meetings.**

We make it **one link.**

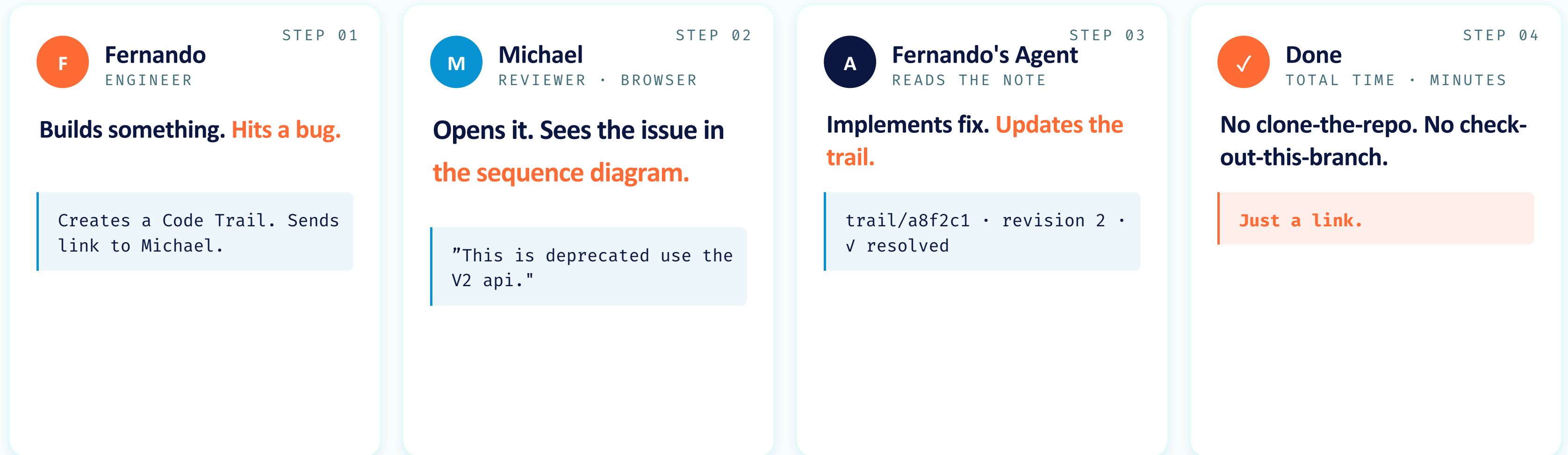


When CEO needs a video, gazillion people have input. When your codebase has multiple owners, same problem.



THE STAKEHOLDER PROBLEM

# Fernando builds. Michael reviews. The agent ships.



~~"Clone my repo." "Check out this branch."~~ Just a link.



# Maintainers hate PRs.

"Sorry, it's just me. So many PRs to go through." — every maintainer, ever.

OPEN PULL REQUESTS

2,847 ↑

|       |                                         |     |
|-------|-----------------------------------------|-----|
| #4471 | fix: prevent crash on empty array input | 3h  |
| #4470 | feat: add dark mode toggle              | 5h  |
| #4469 | refactor: split renderer into modules   | 6h  |
| #4468 | docs: typo in README install section    | 9h  |
| #4467 | chore: bump dependencies for security   | 12h |
| #4466 | feat: support websocket reconnect       | 1d  |
| #4465 | test: cover edge cases for parser       | 1d  |
| #4464 | perf: cache compiled regex              | 2d  |

...and 2,839 more.

PRS

show what changed.

CODE TRAILS

Show what they intend

Understanding what code does: **hard.**

Verifying code does what you think it does:

**easy.**

WE MAKE THE SECOND ONE VISUAL.



# The competition, plainly.

|               |                                                                |
|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Jira tickets  | Like using a hammer to put in a screw. Works, but feels wrong. |
| Linear        | Task management that isn't native to code.                     |
| PRs on GitHub | Here's 4 files that changed. Figure out what they do.          |
| Code Trails   | Here's exactly what this does, visually, with context.         |

# ~~A product requirement doc.~~ It's a **piece of one.**

**Simple. Specific. Shareable.**

One PRD

CONTAINER

- [trail/a8f2c1](#) auth flow refactor
- [trail/b3e10d](#) db schema migration
- [trail/c7d4e2](#) rate limit policy
- [trail/d9a2b1](#) error boundary fix
- [trail/e1f8c6](#) worker queue cleanup

EACH TRAIL IS A THOUGHT ABOUT CODE YOU WANT TO SHARE.

# The same artifact. **Two lifetimes.**

TODAY

**Share code changes with a link.**

A trail helps Sarah understand the change. She leaves a note.  
Done.

TOMORROW

**One button creates OTEL  
monitoring.**

That same Code Trail becomes the contract for what  
production should do.

**When execution **drifts from intent**, you know instantly.**

STORY-BASED MONITORING • NOT "IS IT UP" • "IS IT DOING WHAT WE DESIGNED"

Can Claude make an artifact with sequence diagrams, spatial views, and explanations?

— Maybe.

But **we own the concept**. We're making it the way people think about code sharing.

It's **Frame.io for code**. Once you see it, you can't unsee how obvious it is.



# Michael opens Principal the next day.

PRINCIPAL • FEED

TODAY

J

Julie created [REDACTED] for the observability demo.

2H AGO

F

Fernando resolved [REDACTED] auth flow refactor.

4H AGO

M

Michael left a note on [REDACTED] db schema migration.

6H AGO

J

Julie opened [REDACTED] rate limit policy for review.

YESTERDAY

NOT

"Julie made ~~50 commits.~~"

BUT

"Julie created **5 trails.**"

NOT

Activity

BUT

**Intent.**

# AI agents generate code **faster than humans can review it.**

Engineers used to read code. Now they need to verify agent work.

READING 10,000 GENERATED LINES

## Impossible.

The old loop doesn't scale to agent output.

REVIEWING A CODE TRAIL

## 15 min

Visual, anchored, shareable. The new loop.

The bottleneck shifted from ~~writing~~ to **understanding**.

We're not making developers ~~code less~~.

**We're helping them understand  
more.**

**One link.**

**No tools.**

**Anyone can participate.**

THE COLLABORATION PRIMITIVE FOR THE AGE OF AI-GENERATED CODE.